PassFrame
TUITION

The Otter's Secret Pool

Year 4 — 11+ Mark Scheme (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension · Mark Scheme

For tutor use. Accept any well-reasoned answer supported by evidence from the extract, even if it differs from the wording below.

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

1. To the secret pool by the river.

2. A little paper boat, carefully folded.

3. "Pip loved the pool because nobody else knew about it…"

4. Accept any 3 of: "looked like a sheet of green glass"; "stood like grey statues"; "as graceful as a dancer"; "shone like gold."

5. Touched or pushed gently.

6. True.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. she wanted whoever made it to be able to find it again, or felt it wasn't hers to keep.

8. A single white feather.

9. Still and glass-like water, willow trees leaning over it, quiet and hidden — a calm spot nobody else knew about.

10. Accept reasoned inference, e.g. it suggests a bird may have been involved, or was simply left behind by accident.

11. A tiny acorn, polished until it shone like gold.

12. Accept a reasoned opinion either way, e.g. yes — it let the boat's owner find it again; or no — she could have left a note instead.

Homework Worksheet — Answers

1. In the morning, before the village woke up.

2. The ducks, the herons, and Old Badger.

3. "…a little paper boat, folded so carefully that it must have taken someone hours to make."

4. Accept any 2 of: "the willow trees leaned over it as if they were whispering secrets"; "before the village had even rubbed the sleep from its eyes."

5. Moving smoothly and elegantly.

6. Correct order: Pip finds a paper boat → Pip searches for footprints → the paper boat disappears → Pip finds an acorn.

7. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. it makes the pool feel special and private, and heightens the mystery of who left the boat.

8. It helps the reader picture them standing completely still and silent.

9. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. surprised or curious, wondering who had taken it.

10. Accept reasoned answers, e.g. that whoever left it wanted to thank her, or cared enough to leave something special in return.

11. It helps the reader picture them standing completely still and silent (same device as above — accept any sensible restatement).

12. Accept any reasoned prediction with a clear link to the text.